

**Spring 2025 UF
Innovation Challenge
by **Deloitte.**
Me In**

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GatorBot

24/7 Student's guide helps students navigate UF bureaucracy

— connecting you to the right office, contact, or form instantly

PROBLEM STATEMENT

- Students struggle to navigate complex university systems and departments.
- Issues often involve multiple offices, leading to confusion and delays. Being redirected without clear guidance.
- Current processes are inefficient and disproportionately affect first-gen & internationals

SUPPORTING EVIDENCE

- Students waste **2-3 hours** navigating disjointed systems
- **60%** of students are unaware of support service
- Equity Gaps: **First-gen (20%)** and **international students (7.4%)** face greater barriers
- Bureaucracy expands, tuition rises, complexity increases
- UF students face real consequences from communication gaps

PROPOSED SOLUTION

An AI-powered student support chatbot, integrated as an extension to ONE.UF can streamline access to university services by instantly connecting students to the right departments, contacts, and resources—*eliminating confusion, saving time, and reducing the stress of navigating complex university bureaucracy.*

Student Challenges at UF: What the Research Shows

UF's support system is decentralized and complex. Students — especially international and first-gen — often don't know where to go for help, leading to stress, delays, and missed opportunities.

1

Invisible workload

2-3 hours spent on routine administrative tasks weekly adds up to over **100 hours per academic year**

2

Lack of Awareness

This gap could turn into an **access gap**, leading to unmet needs, and a preventable drop in student retention

3

Stress & Inequity

Nearly **1 in 4 UF students** are more likely to struggle with navigating campus bureaucracy due to unfamiliarity

4

Growing bureaucracy

As administrative structures expand, students face **more layers, more redirects, and more confusion**

5

Uncertainty at UF

The lack of transparency, sends the message that **students are on their own** — can lead to missed deadlines, financial stress

What Is Gator Bot?



1 Invisible workload
Gator Bot saves students
2–3 hours/week

2 Lack of Awareness
Makes hidden resources
discoverable in one place

3 Stress & Inequity
Provides culturally-aware,
accessible, and simplified
information

4 Growing bureaucracy
Bypasses unnecessary
layers and redirections

5 Uncertainty at UF
Delivers immediate clarity where
office communication may fall
short

6 Strategic Support Tool
Augments—not replaces—UF
staff by reducing repetitive
inquiries, saving time for both
students and departments, and
improving operational efficiency.

Key Principles

- No personal data is stored by default
- End-to-end encryption
- No access to academic records
- Secure infrastructure
Optional data deletion

Solution Components

A breakdown of what powers Gator Bot and how it works behind the scenes

1

AI Chatbot Interface

A conversational interface where students can ask free-form questions 24/7 through ONE.UF

2

Knowledge Base + Department Directory

Stores UF-specific workflows, FAQs, contacts, forms, and policies across all major departments.

3

Repeated Usage Rate

Matches user questions with the most relevant information from the knowledge base.

4

Cross-Department Mapping Logic

Handles multi-issue questions that involve more than one office or workflow.

5

Security & Privacy Layer

Ensures no sensitive data is stored without consent. Anonymous query logging by default.

→ *Complies with FERPA and UF IT privacy guidelines.*

6

Feedback & Analytics System

Allows users to rate responses and collects usage data to improve accuracy and coverage.

Implementation & Strategy

Implementation strategy, FERPA-safe design, and scalability with ONE.UF

1

Phased Rollout Plan

Stakeholder interviews through campus-wide launch

2

Modular AI Ecosystem

Chatbot integrated with ONE.UF system

3

Data Infrastructure & Intergration

Centralized data with real-time connections.

4

Automated and Personalized Support

Tailored guidance for urgent student issues

5

User Feedback and Learning Loop

Continuous improvement through student input

6

Privacy and Security First

FERPA-compliant with encrypted data handling

Modular AI Ecosystem with Privacy First

AI Ecosystem

- > Centralized support for student services
- > Pulls One.UF directory data (no grades)
- > Modules: chatbot, alerts, recommendations
- > Designed for multi-platform support

Secure and FERPA-Compliant by Design

- > All data encrypted in transit and at rest
- > No access to grades or protected records
- > No data stored by default; deletion supported
- > Built for auditability and student trust

Success Measurement

A set of clear metrics to ensure Gator Bot is delivering value, solving real problems, and improving student experience

1

The number of users

Active users from usage logs

2

Query volumes

Total number of queries over time

3

Repeat usage rate

Percentage of returning users

4

Qualitative feedback

Collect anonymous feedback on ease of use and usefulness

5

Follow-up survey

"Did this answer your question?"
"Did this help with your situation?"

6

Staff satisfaction

Feedback from departments about how useful the chatbot is reducing their workload

Solution Impacts

Short-term Impacts (New Students)

- Improves equity in service access and reduces dropout risks due to confusion or missed deadlines.
- Helps those most affected by UF's complex systems navigate support services with clarity.
- Builds confidence in self-advocacy by breaking down steps and contacts clearly.
- Provides multilingual-friendly, culturally aware guidance through the chatbot.

Long-term Impacts (All UF Students)

- Streamlines support, learns from student input, and boosts satisfaction and retention at UF.
- Becomes a universal tool integrated into One.UF that assists every student with administrative needs.
- Sets a precedent for UF as a leader in student-centered innovation and tech-forward support.

Demonstration

Question: I'm having a conflict within my student organization, and internal communication isn't working. I need help resolving this. Who do I go to

